The Hon. Alexander Mackenzie.

(From the Kingston News, Tory)

The history of Great Britain and her colonies is full of instances of men rising from the lower ranks of life by manly and honorable efforts to the highest offices of state; in fact the highest honor and greatest responsibility in the State. It has been the pride of the Empire that its political, legal, and military leaders have been selected irrespective of birth or wealth. Among the Dominion we have had a number of men who have risen from the humblest walks in life to the highest offices in the gift of the people. Among the latter we may mention Hon. Alexander Mackenzie, the present Premier of the Dominion. Mr. Mackenzie was born in Scotland, and came to Canada when a young man. He settled in Kingston, and followed the occupation of a stone mason. He was not long in Canada before he began to take an active interest in public affairs, and was soon recognized as a leader of the Reform party. He was elected to the Legislature for Lambton, and represented that constituency for many years. He was a member of the Executive Council in the Government of Mr. Brown, and was Minister of Public Works in the Government of Mr. Sandfield Macdonald. He was also a member of the Executive Council in the Government of Mr. John Sandfield Macdonald, and was Provincial Treasurer in the Government of Mr. Edward Blake. He was a member of the Executive Council in the Government of Mr. Blake, and was Minister of Public Works in the Government of Mr. Letellier de St. Just. He was a member of the Executive Council in the Government of Mr. Blake, and was Minister of Public Works in the Government of Mr. Joly